

The AI Pendulum

Centralized team. Then everyone goes rogue. Then guardrails in the middle. Most companies are on their third model in 18 months.

01

Centralized AI Team

One team owns every tool, every prompt, every workflow. Safe, slow, and the line of process owners outside their door gets long fast.

02

Wild West

Let every team go pick their own tools. Curiosity spikes. So does the credit card bill. The \$20k surprise invoice usually shows up around month four.

03

Guardrails in the Middle

Centralized cost and tool guardrails. Process owners keep final say. Curiosity stays alive. The bill stops surprising anyone.

SKIP THE FIRST TWO

Day-One Setup

- 01 Set a per-team monthly AI spend cap before anyone signs up for anything
- 02 Name a process owner for every workflow you want AI to touch
- 03 Approve a short list of tools, leave room for two experiments per team
- 04 Review the bill and the wins together, monthly, in the same meeting

Pay the curiosity tax. Skip the chaos tax.

The middle was always the answer. You don't have to live through the first two phases to earn it.